

NICHOLAS REYNOLDS

nicholas-reynolds.com
nicholas.reynolds@essex.ac.uk

Current positions and affiliations

University of Essex, Department of Economics
Lecturer, July 2020 – present

Institute for Fiscal Studies
Visiting Research Scholar, 2026

IZA Institute of Labor Economics
Research Fellow, 2024–present

Education

PhD, Economics, Brown University, 2020
MA, Economics, Brown University, 2015
BA, Economics and Environmental Studies, Haverford College, 2011

Peer-reviewed publications

“The Broad Decline in Health and Human Capital of Americans Born after 1947”

American Economic Review: Insights

June 2025

Lead article (selected by editor)

“Increased Mortality of White Americans and a Decline in the Health of Cohorts Born after WWII”

Journal of Human Resources

May 2026

“The Paper Trail of Knowledge Spillovers: Evidence from Patent Interferences”

(with Ina Ganguli and Jeffrey Lin)

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics

April 2020

Working papers

“Spreading Out Across Expanding Idea Space”

(with Ina Ganguli, Jeffrey Lin, and Vitaly Meursault)

March 2026

Subsumes and extends previous working paper “Patent Text and Long-Run Innovation Dynamics: The Critical Role of Model Selection” (NBER WP, September 2024).

Presented at NBER Summer Institute 2025; scheduled for NBER Summer Institute 2026.

“Three Regimes of Human Development in Twentieth-Century America: Biological Growth, Health, and Human Capital”

March 2026

Subsumes and extends previous working paper “Stunted Adolescence: The Anomalous Growth Pattern of Americans Born in the 1960s” IZA Discussion Paper, July 2025.

Presented at LSE Historical Economic Demography Working Group and Harvard/BU Economic History Seminar.

“The Signature of a Mid-century Cohort Malaise”

(with Sam Arenberg and Sam Stripling)

November 2025

Presented at Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia and Brookings Institution.

“Candidate Origins of the Recent Stagnation in Midlife Mortality in the United States”

(with Sam Arenberg and Sam Stripling)

April 2025

Presented at NBER Summer Institute 2025

“Local Average Cohort Effects”

October 2024

Selected work-in-progress

“Deindustrialization as a Double-edged Sword: Employment and Environmental Effects”

(with Michel Serafinelli)

“Sorting, Neighborhood Effects, and Intergenerational Mobility in Spatial Equilibrium”

(with Jeffrey Lin and Bryan Stuart)

“Falling Shares and a Diverging Top Tail: The Distribution of Income Across and Within Cohorts in the United States”

Research Grants and Funding Activity

“Why did health and human capital decline for Americans born after 1947, and was there a similar decline in the United Kingdom and Canada?” BA/Leverhulme Small Research Grant, PI, £9,928

“Mid-century cohort health and human capital reversal: global or US-only?”

Leverhulme Trust Research Project Grant, PI

Invited full application following outline review

£165,240 requested

“Deindustrialization as a Double-edged Sword: Employment & Environmental Effects”

Leverhulme Trust Research Project Grant, Co-I (PI: Michel Serafinelli)

Invited full application following outline review

£257,685 requested

Non-academic writing

“What caused the American decline of the past 60 years?”

LSE Business Review, October 2025

Teaching Experience:

University of Essex:

Undergraduate Health Economics, 2021-2025

PhD Applied Research Methods (Causal Inference), 2021-2024

Masters-level Introduction to Economics and Public Policy (co-lecturer) 2023-2025

Brown University:

Labor and Population (PhD-level Empirical Methods and Causal Inference)

teaching fellow for Professor Kenneth Chay, 2018

1st Year PhD Macroeconomics

teaching fellow for Professor Neil Mehrotra and Professor Gauti Eggertson, 2016

teaching fellow for Professor Oded Galor and Professor Peter Howitt, 2015

Presentations

- 2026 Harvard/BU, LSE Historical Economic Demography Workshop, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Brookings Institution, NBER Summer Institute (Macroeconomics and Productivity, scheduled)
- 2025 NBER Summer Institute (Aging session and Innovation session, presented by coauthors)
- 2024 LSE Historical Economic Demography Workshop, Scottish Economic Society Annual Meeting, Essen Health Economics Seminar, RWI - Leibniz Institute for Economic Research, European Economic Association Annual Meeting (cancelled)
- 2023 European Economic Association Annual Meeting
- 2022 Human Mortality Database Symposium
- 2021 NBER Summer Institute (Aging session and Health session), European Economic Association Annual Meeting, European Association of Labor Economics Annual Conference
- 2020 University of Essex, Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Lehigh University, TRENDS meeting (at University of Michigan, sponsored by National Institute on Aging), Max Planck/NBER Workshop on Ageing and Health (planned but cancelled due to Covid)
- 2019 Population Association of America Annual Meeting, Human Mortality Database Symposium (Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research), Population Health Science Research Workshop (University of Pennsylvania)
- 2018 Population Association of America Annual Meeting, Population Health Science Research Workshop (Boston University)

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships:

- 2022-, Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (D2)
- 2019-2020, Demography Trainee of NIH T32 Training Grant
- 2017-2019, NBER Predoctoral Fellow, Economics of an Aging Labor Force
- 2016-2017, Demography Trainee of NIH T32 Training Grant
- 2017, 3rd Year Paper Prize, Brown Economics
- 2016, Graduate Teaching Award, Brown Economics
- 2016, Distinction, 2nd Year Field Exam, Brown Economics

Doctoral supervisees

- Aitor Irastorza-Fadrique, University of Essex, 2023
Placement: Institute for Fiscal Studies
(co-supervisor)

Updated March 2026

Elena Faieta, University of Essex, in progress
(co-lead supervisor)
Pavel Tupketov, University of Essex, in progress
(co-lead supervisor)

Referee service

Journal of Political Economy, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS), Journal of Urban Economics, European Economic Review, Journal of Economic Inequality, Rapid Reviews: COVID-19

References:

Professor Anna Aizer
Department of Economics
Brown University
+1-(401) 863-9529
Anna_Aizer@brown.edu

Dr. Jeffrey Lin
Vice President and Economist
Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia
+1-(215) 574-3441
jeff.lin@phil.frb.org

Professor Ina Ganguli
Department of Economics
University of Massachusetts Amherst
+1-(617) 230-6296
lganguli@umass.edu

Dr. Michel Serafinelli
King's Business School
King's College London
+44-2078480208
Michel.serafinelli@kcl.ac.uk